

THE CUTS — EXPLAINED IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Two shoots, two purposes

Updated: today at Victor's site (Vista). Tony testimonials filmed separately.

Read this once before the shoot.

Why two shoots, not one

Victor (VIP General Contractor) just signed with Scale SD. He has no measurable results yet. He's brand new.

Tony (World Pools Inc) has been a client long enough that we have actual numbers — busy calendar, real revenue, "too busy to count" verbatim.

You can't film a testimonial when there's nothing to testify to. So:

- **Today (May 6) at Victor's site:** we shoot Peter solo cuts (5, 6, 7, 8, 9), b-roll of Victor's bathroom remodel, and a short "I'm just starting with these guys" intro from Victor. **6 cuts total.** Honest. No results claimed.
- **Tony shoot (separate, this week):** we shoot Tony testimonial cuts (1, 2, 3, 4, 10) at Tony's pool site. He has real numbers to share.

Editor combines both into the 6-7 final ads at Friday launch.

Audience rule (still applies, both shoots)

The AUDIENCE we call out in copy is **"high-ticket San Diego home service contractors"** broadly — GCs, HVAC, roofers, plumbers, remodelers, hardscape, pools.

We don't single out a single trade. Why: per Fathom strategy lock, Scale SD doesn't compete with same-trade competitors of existing clients. Calling out "pool builders"

would target Tony's competitors. Calling out "GCs" would (eventually) target Victor's. So we stay broad.

Tony at his pool site is the visual proof. Victor at his bathroom remodel is the visual proof. Neither cut narrows the audience to a single trade.

Today's 6 cuts at Victor's site

CUT V — "Victor Intro" (NEW)

What it is: Victor talking 10-15 seconds. Just himself, no Peter.

What he says (his own words, no script): - "I'm Victor." - "I'm a general contractor in Vista." - "I do bathroom remodels, kitchens, water damage, tile, cabinets." - "I just signed with Scale SD this week. We'll see what happens."

Why we shoot this: Victor doesn't have results yet. So we don't fake a testimonial. We document day 1. Honest. "He just started with us, here's where he is." Two months from now, this becomes the "before" cut paired against his actual results. Today it just establishes him as a real, local, working contractor.

Why honesty wins: every other agency fakes results. We show day 1 transparently. That's a credibility move competitors can't copy without changing how they operate.

CUT 5 — "5-Second Anchor"

What it is: A super-short ad. 5 seconds. Peter alone, looking at the camera, says one short line.

What Peter says: *"San Diego contractors. Your work isn't the problem. Your system is."*

Why we shoot it: Spark Marketing's #2 longest-running ad is 5 seconds long. Cesar literally says 6 spoken words. That ad has been running 140+ days. 5-second ads work. We mirror the format.

What goes around the words: the editor adds bullet text overlays in post. Peter doesn't say "90 exclusive leads in 12 weeks" — that's overlay text.

Takes: 5-7 times. Pick the cleanest in edit.

CUT 6 — "Contractors, Summer Window"

What it is: A 15-second ad. Peter alone, walking through Victor's finished bathroom or active install area, talking while walking. Movement keeps people watching.

What Peter says: *"San Diego contractors. Summer is 90 days. Are you booked or are you winging it? Every homeowner about to drop big money on a remodel, a pool, an HVAC install — they're on Instagram right now. If they're not seeing your work, they're seeing your competitor's."*

Why we shoot it: Summer is 90 days from May 6. Every high-ticket trade has a summer-revenue dependency — GCs do summer remodels, HVAC does installs, roofers race rainy season, pools panic in spring.

What people watching this think: "Shit. Summer's coming and I'm not booked. He's right."

CUT 7 — "Burned Bob Confession"

What it is: A 30-45 second ad. Peter alone, no smile, vulnerable confession tone.

What Peter says: *"Real talk. If you're a San Diego contractor and you've already paid an agency \$2k a month for six months and got dashboards full of clicks and zero jobs booked, this is for you. Look. You're not crazy. The reason it didn't work isn't ads. It's that the agency never came to your job site. Stock-template campaigns can't sell your work because they don't show your work. Behind me right now is Victor. VIP General Contractor. Vista, CA. He just signed with us. We're going to film his work for the next 12 weeks and run it as ads. The contractor we already have hard numbers for is Tony at World Pools. He's locked up his summer. That's where Victor's headed. 90 exclusive leads in 12 weeks. If we don't hit it, you don't pay."*

Why this ad's language is so good: It's honest about Victor (just signed, no claims). It cites Tony as the proof (real results). It separates the testimonial from the visual setting. Most agency ads conflate "client behind me" with "results," which is misleading. Ours doesn't.

Why this ad goes on the Video Landing Page (Track B): skeptical buyers click slower. Track B uses a longer landing page experience that pre-qualifies them. By the time they fill out the form, they've heard the whole pitch. This ad fits that audience.

CUT 8 — "Job Site Walkthrough"

What it is: A 30-45 second ad. Peter walks Victor's site and narrates what's being built. Dani follows on the gimbal.

What Peter does (unscripted): 1. Front of site: "Hey, we're at a job site in Vista with one of our newest clients, Victor at VIP General Contractor." 2. Walks to active work: describes the bathroom remodel, points at materials. 3. Walks to a finished detail: shows quality. Casual aside. 4. Lands at Victor: "This is Victor. Just signed this week. We're going to film his work for 12 weeks. He does the work, we do the marketing." 5. Tag to camera: "If you're a contractor in San Diego — any high-ticket trade — and you want this kind of partnership, link's below."

Why we shoot this: This is the "show, don't tell" ad. Other ads tell you we go to job sites. This one shows you. Documenting day 1 with Victor is more honest than faking a 6-month testimonial.

CUT 9 — "Hook Bank" (this is the building block, not an ad)

What it is: NOT a finished ad. It's a collection of 7 OPENING LINES we shoot today and use across many ads in editing.

What Peter does: stands against a clean wall. Looks at the camera. Delivers each of these 7 lines as its own clip:

1. "If you're a high-ticket contractor in San Diego and you want a fully booked summer, watch this."
2. "Most contractors are buying leads that 4 other guys already called."
3. "Your phone should be ringing every day. If it's not, this is why."
4. "Slow season doesn't exist for the contractors using this."
5. "GCs, HVAC, roofers, pools, plumbing, hardscape — if you do high-ticket work in San Diego, this is for you."
6. "San Diego contractors. There's a guy a mile from you booking jobs you should have. The difference isn't talent."
7. "Want a fully booked summer? Stop hustling for referrals. Start advertising in front of real buyers."

We shoot each one twice. 14 total takes.

How we use them: in edit, we make 7 versions of Cut 5 — each with a DIFFERENT opener. Run all 7 versions on Meta at \$5/day for 3 days. Whichever opener gets the most clicks becomes our default for the next 30 days.

Why this is the most leverage we get all day: 14 takes. 10 minutes of shooting. Powers our hook testing for 90 days.

Tony shoot (SEPARATE — within 7 days)

These 5 cuts get filmed at a Tony shoot, scheduled separately. Tony at his pool site, Peter prompting.

CUT 1 — "Too Busy to Count"

Conversation. Peter asks Tony how many leads we sent last month. Tony hedges. Peter pulls phone for receipts. Peter says "this guy's too busy to count, that's a good thing."

CUT 2 — "How Long, How Much"

Conversation. Same format, but pulls a revenue number. Tony lowballs, Peter fact-checks.

CUT 3 — "Phone Before / Phone Now"

Conversation. Pain to relief. What was the phone like before, what is it like now.

CUT 4 — "Summer Locked Up"

Tony solo monologue. Peer-to-peer. "Times are changing. If your March is slow you're cooked."

CUT 10 — "Tony Tagline Tag"

Tony 5-second closing line. Used as ending on multiple ads in edit.

How the cuts become 6-7 final ads at Friday launch

Final ad	Built from	Status
Picking Jobs (15s)	Tony Cut 1 + Cut 10 tag	Needs Tony shoot

Final ad	Built from	Status
Summer Window (30s)	Cut 6 (today) + b-roll	Today
Burned Bob Confession (45s)	Cut 7 (today) + b-roll	Today
Phone Before/Now (30s)	Tony Cut 3 + Cut 4 b-roll	Needs Tony shoot
5-Second Teaser (5s)	Cut 5 (today) + Hook from Cut 9	Today
Static Ad	Tad designs from b-roll stills	Needs Tony b-roll
Day-1 Documentary (30s, BONUS)	Cut V + Cut 8	Today only — bonus ad

4 ads ready from today's shoot. Tony shoot unlocks 2-3 more. Final launch: 6-7 ads.

The simple version

Cut	Where	Who	One sentence
V	Today, Victor's site	Victor solo	Honest 10-15s "I'm Victor, I just signed, here we go."
5	Today, Victor's site	Peter solo	5-second hook, mirrors Cesar's longest 5s teaser.
6	Today, Victor's site	Peter walking	15s urgency ad, "Summer is 90 days."
7	Today, Victor's site	Peter solo confession	30-45s for the agency-burned crowd. References Tony as proof.
8	Today, Victor's site	Peter walks site	30-45s walkthrough documenting day 1 with Victor.
9	Today, Victor's site	Peter quickfire	7 opening lines as building blocks.
1	Tony shoot	Tony + Peter	Conversation about lead volume. Hedge + receipts pull.
2	Tony shoot	Tony + Peter	Conversation about revenue. Hedge + receipts pull.

Cut	Where	Who	One sentence
3	Tony shoot	Tony + Peter	Conversation about phone before vs phone now.
4	Tony shoot	Tony solo	Tony peer-to-peer monologue about why marketing matters.
10	Tony shoot	Tony solo	5-second closing line, used as ending tag on multiple ads.

Why this two-shoot setup is actually smarter

1. **Today's shoot is short.** 3-3.5 hours. Faster, less talent fatigue.
 2. **Honesty about Victor.** No fake testimonial. We show day 1 transparently.
 3. **Tony's testimonial gets its own dedicated shoot** at his actual pool site — best visual, best audio, best b-roll.
 4. **Editor has more material.** Two shoots = wider asset library = more flexibility in edit + future repurposing.
 5. **Sets up perpetual content engine.** Today's "before" footage of Victor pairs with his future testimonial in 12 weeks. Built-in case study coming.
-

Print this. Read it once before the shoot. Don't bring it to set. Bring the SHOOTING-SCRIPTS document to set. Last updated: 2026-05-06 — split-shoot strategy.